Animal Hoarding

S	W	A		E	S	U		M	C	A
E	H	R	N	P	L	S	N	A	K	
L		B	F			K	R		H	S
	L		L	N	T	U		K	E	Y
O	E	Z	A	D	H	A	P	B	L	N
O	L		M	A	C	L	A	E	E	I
P	I	G	I	N	K	L		B		U
S		U	N	K	O	I	R	E	H	G
O		L		O	A		O	A	A	N
	O	C	O	R		O	T		N	E
	U	C	K		A	G	L	E	T	
T	A		T		B	B	A	R	E	D



__ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __

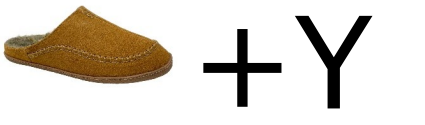
© 2023 David Garber

Argument Checker

I keep finding fundamental logical holes in our reports. That seems like a bad idea.



_____ _____
1



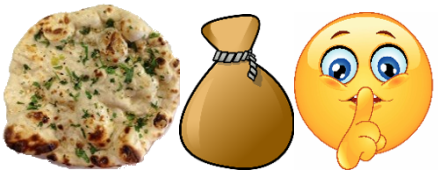
2



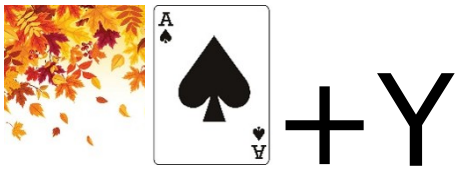
3



4



___ _____
5



6





7



8

These examples might help, but you don't need them. They are alphabetical, not answer order.

My code isn't buggy, you're just too stupid to understand.
I met Dave Cutler in an elevator, and he told me these lines of code could never go wrong in any situation.
No one checked in any bugs on Mon or Thu, so this was a bug free week.
This code has no bugs, and as a result I concluded we have bug free code.
There can't be any bugs in Python code, and as a result my code is all bug free.
The food in our cafeteria is terrible, and thus our code has few bugs.
Have you noticed how badly designed our website is? We need to consider that before product bugs.
Fixing this bug undermines our architecture and will be the beginning of the end of our design-pattern led approach.
You're implying I don't care but I've checked for compiler warnings or test failures. I'm doing everything I can to address bugs.

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__ __ __ __ __ __ __ __
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

Big Ideas

Cut the 32 tiles at the dotted lines and use the word pairs at the tile edges to rearrange them.

Tiles do not rotate. Word pairs read left to right or top to bottom.

Letters are underlined only to clarify their correct orientation.

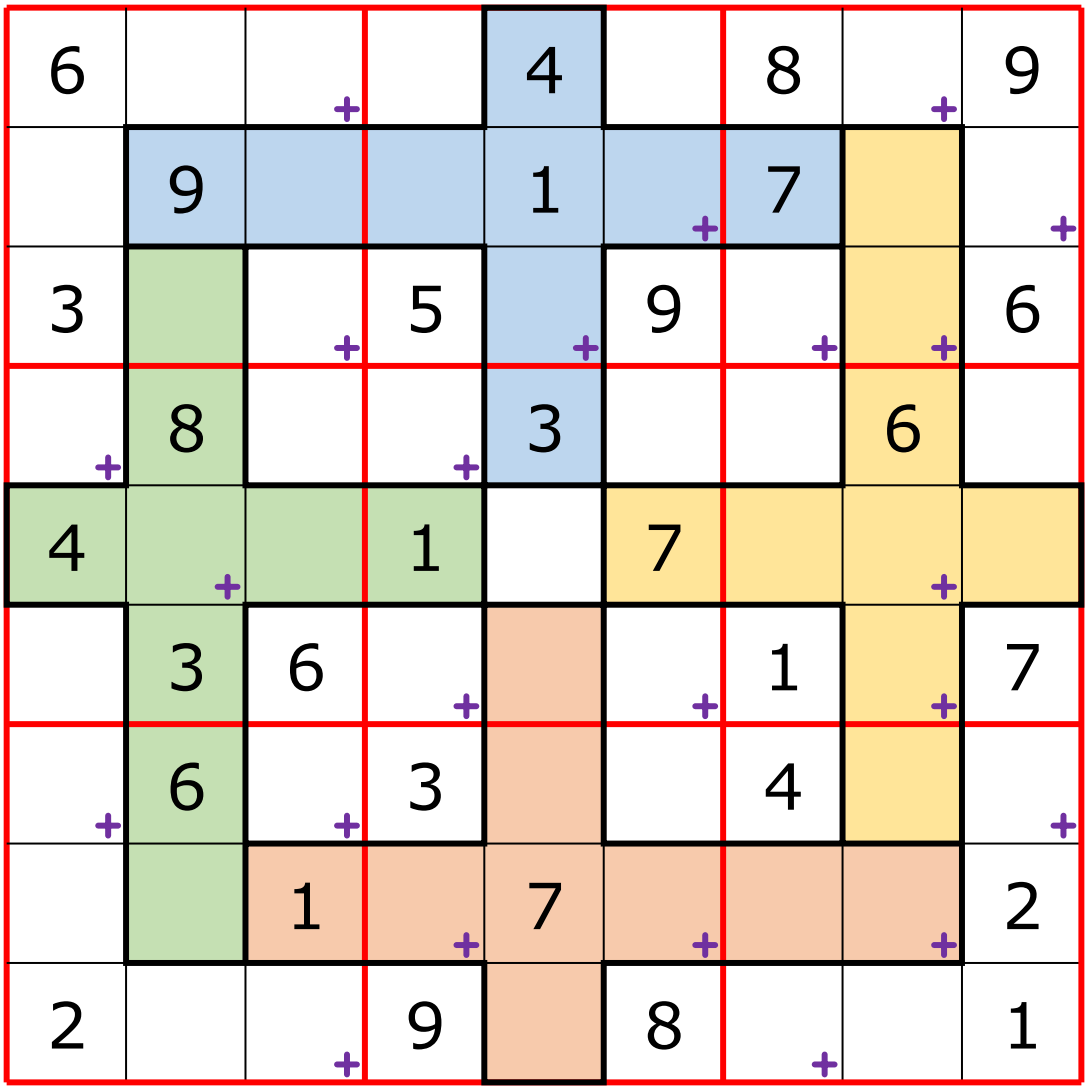
Finally, read off the 32 large centre letters to get a clue for the two word final answer.

power **A** pasteurised	circuit **A** fridge method camera	puzzle **C** steel head	rotation **C** alphabet bulb fire	**C** Velcro receiver sailing	machine **E** nuclear sequence
saddle **E** integral	**F** biology mirror	powder **F** pencil mixer number	grinder **H** scientific cell crop	reflector **H** spoken screw compass	**I** evolutionary patch analogue
I hay railway	beam **N** gas telephone	soap **O** concrete engine Turing	film **O** typewriter letters hand	**O** language crossword	box **P** eraser
brush **P** genetic milk	system **R** energy	plough **R** anasthetic ribbon gun	press **R** antibiotic calculus electric	**S** radio river	clock **S** water bill integrated
starter **S** steam medicine tooth	point **T** nail door agricultural	paper **T** battery toilet airplane	wings **T** light rim printing	dam **T** internal bale writing	control **U** wheel horse
ship **V** dollar combustion lens	tracks **W** flush birth				

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Four Crosses

This grid works like Sudoku but with stacked layers. Each large 3×3 square that is outlined red must contain each of the digits 1-9 once. There are four overlaid crosses, outlined in black and each shaded in a different colour. Each cross has 9 squares and also must contain the digits 1-9. As usual, there may be no repeated digits in any column or row. Ignore the + signs in the bottom right of some cells until you have solved the grid.



Once you have solved the grid, sum cells with purple + signs in the bottom right. Sum separately for each of the nine rows, and convert those numbers to letters. Read off in order, top to bottom. There is a tenth letter, which is the same as the fourth.

Final Answer: _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _

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Elective Operations

Below are a collection of equations, whose operators have been removed. In their place are dotted outlines. Your challenge is to figure out which operators will correctly solve the equation. You have 5 operators to choose from: addition (+), subtraction (−), multiplication (×), division (/), and modulo (%). PEMDAS rules apply, but when in doubt, always resolve operations left-to-right.

Write operators into the blank spaces with the dotted outlines: ◯ and ⏢ . Operators are often used more than once within a row. Different shapes indicate different operators, while a repeated shape indicates the same operator has been used again. The operator ↔ shape connection changes each row.

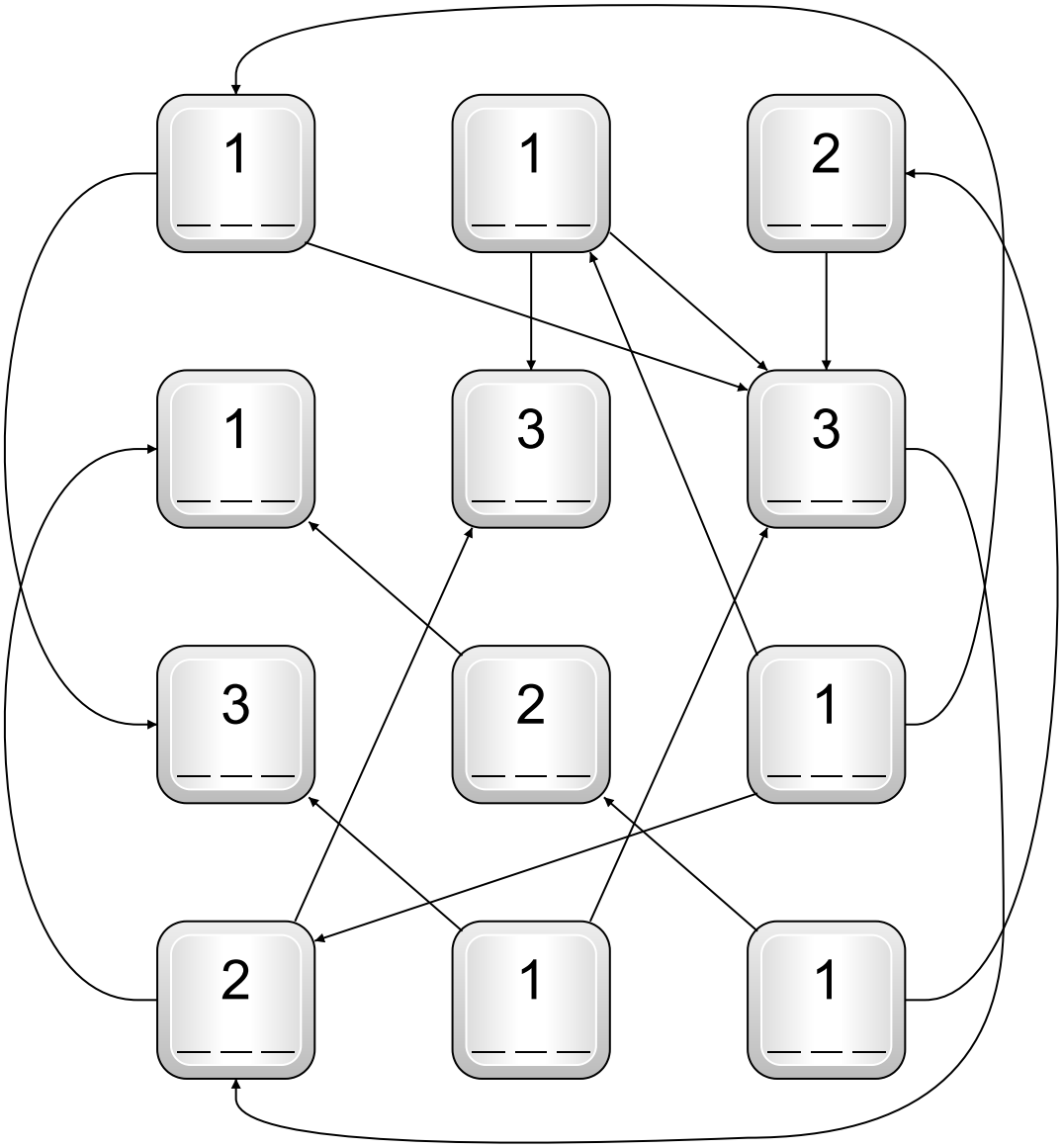
Once you decide which operators solve your needs, mark the ones you used in the table to the right. Bit by bit (actually bit^5), those marked choices will reveal your final answer.

Equations	div	mod	add	mult	sub	bit^5
4 ◯ 4 ◯ 4 ⏢ 8 ⏢ 8 = 1	/	%	+	×	−	☐
20 ◯ 5 ◯ 6 ◯ 7 = 2	/	%	+	×	−	☐
72 ◯ 2 ◯ 3 ◯ 4 = 3	/	%	+	×	−	☐
99 ◯ 25 ◯ 15 ⏢ 5 = 4	/	%	+	×	−	☐
2 ◯ 1 ◯ 2 = 5	/	%	+	×	−	☐
4 ◯ 3 ◯ 3 ⏢ 6 ⏢ 1 = 6	/	%	+	×	−	☐
3 ◯ 1 ⏢ 3 ◯ 1 ⏢ 3 = 7	/	%	+	×	−	☐
81 ◯ 21 ◯ 10 = 8	/	%	+	×	−	☐
25 ◯ 7 ◯ 5 ◯ 3 ◯ 1 = 9	/	%	+	×	−	☐
2 ◯ 1 ◯ 5 ◯ 1 = 10	/	%	+	×	−	☐

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Back Alley Deal

I got an amazing deal on a new cell phone from a guy in a trench coat and dark glasses in a back alley. The numbers on the keypad are all screwed up and the letter trios are missing completely, but who cares, the price was just too good to be true! Now if I can just decipher this weird instruction manual…

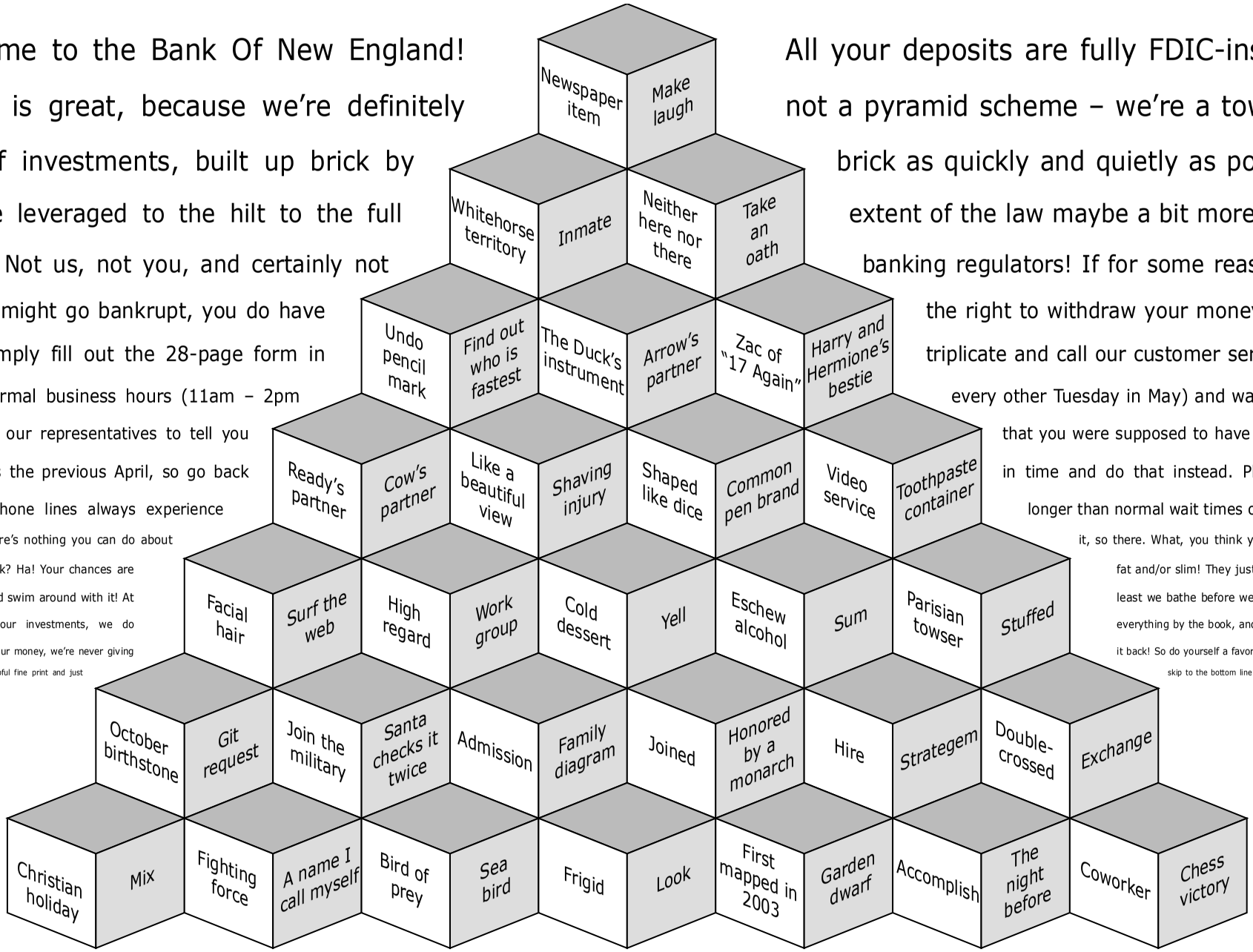


Acid secreted by ants	Give to charity	Ninth-highest mountain Nanga _____	Presidential absolution for a crime
Didn't remember	Ill-_____ gains	One who soaks in a tub	Shrek's best friend
Disney's famous mouse	Male parent	Pirate's pet	Spoiled or decayed
"_____ down the hatches!"	Muscle-bone connector	Plump up, e.g. the calf	Swap tire locations

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Bank Of New England

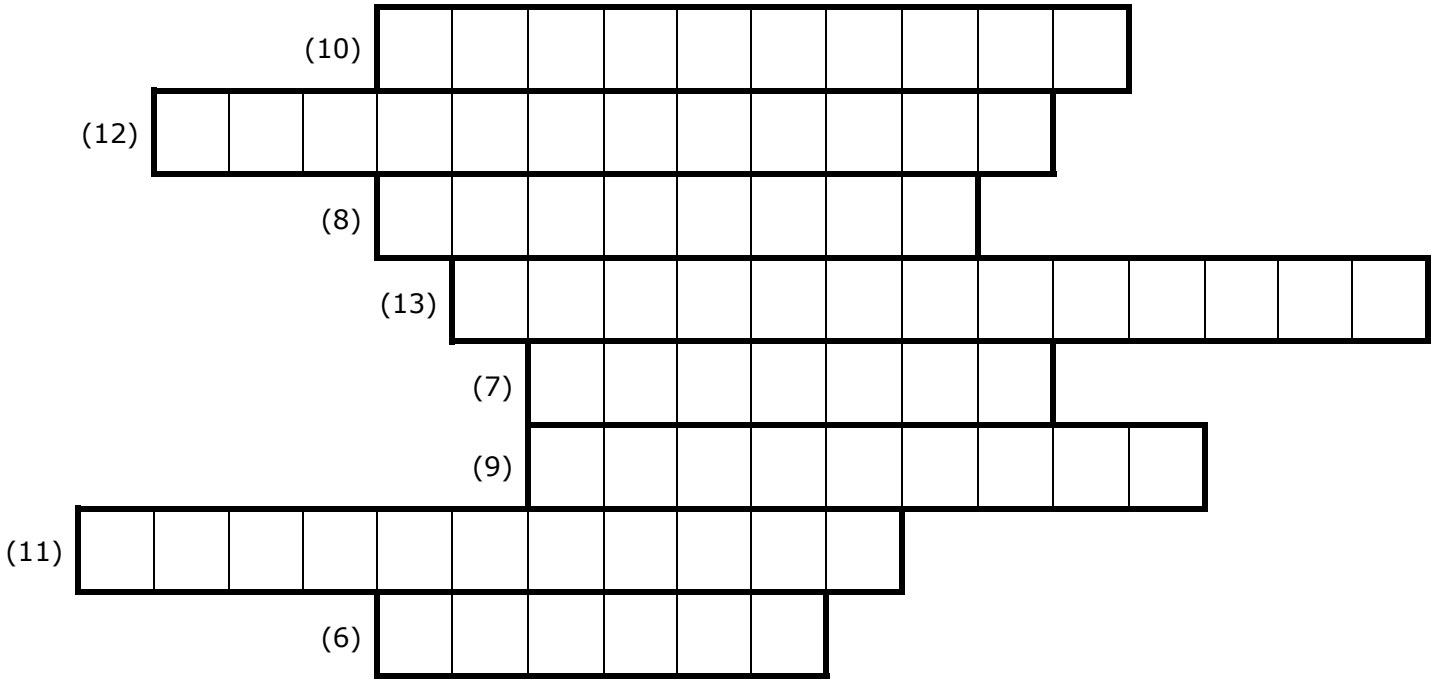
Welcome to the Bank Of New England! All your deposits are fully FDIC-insured. Which is great, because we're definitely not a pyramid scheme – we're a towering web of investments, built up brick by brick as quickly and quietly as possible. We are leveraged to the hilt to the full extent of the law maybe a bit more – who knows! Not us, not you, and certainly not banking regulators! If for some reason you fear we might go bankrupt, you do have the right to withdraw your money at any time. Simply fill out the 28-page form in triplicate and call our customer service line during normal business hours (11am – 2pm every other Tuesday in May) and wait on hold for one of our representatives to tell you that you were supposed to have FAXed the form to us the previous April, so go back in time and do that instead. Please note that our phone lines always experience longer than normal wait times on a normal basis, and there's nothing you can do about it, so there. What, you think you'll do better at another bank? Ha! Your chances are fat and/or slim! They just put your cash in a big tub and swim around with it! At least we bathe before we dive in! When it comes to your investments, we do everything by the book, and our book says, once we've got your money, we're never giving it back! So do yourself a favor and stop reading this completely unhelpful fine print and just skip to the bottom line and SIGN IT already!



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Hold My Beer

Sometimes you just need to have your hands free before taking questionable actions. To the casual O*BSE*RV*ER*, there's no connection between these words. However, a HOME*BR*E*W**ER* might be quick to spot it. Once you notice, you'll understand what type of person might ask you to hang onto their frosty *BE**VER*AGE.



Clues:

- scientific measuring cup
- some say beauty is in their eye
- popular book, perhaps?
- important tool for smoothies
- puzzle that taunts your cerebellum
- one who betrays their allies (alternatively, one who writes the letter X twice)
- one who misappropriates funds
- world traveler (or perhaps a member of a comedy basketball team?)



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HR Guidelines

These are all bad ideas, but which one is the worst?

Lots of action while stealing cattle	_ _ _ □ _ _
Pelvic joint gets a tear	_ □ _
Being modest when there's thunder	_ _ □ _ _ _
Mist during a demolition	_ _ _ □
An axe that can only be turned in one direction	_ _ _ □ _ _ _
I don't like to evaluate	_ □ _ _
Listen to the back	_ _ _ □
Conceal a roller coaster	_ _ □ _
A horse's foot on top of your house	_ _ _ □
Joking gossip	_ _ _ _ □
Headwear on a rodent	_ □ _
Color regret	_ □ _
A dog that is circular	_ _ _ _ □

___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___

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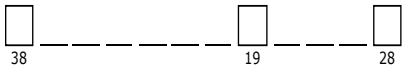
Judging By Its Cover

This is a music identification puzzle.

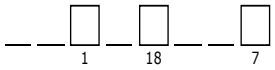
Type titles of these cover songs directly into the page. Press **Enter** to toggle music on the current line. **Refresh** to reload or start over.

While you may enjoy these songs, it may be bad idea to look for the originals - many are far too catchy.

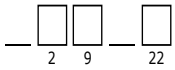
Medieval



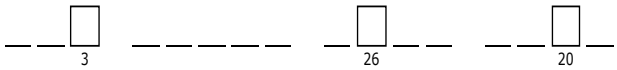
String trio



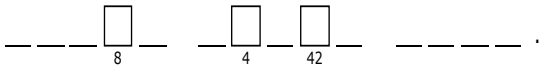
Bagpipes



Marching band



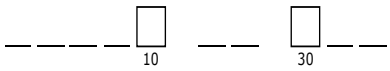
Piano



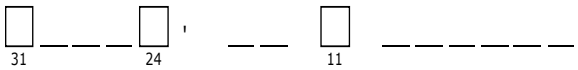
Accordion



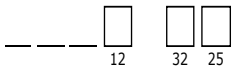
String trio



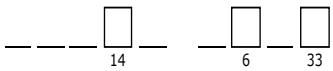
Marching band



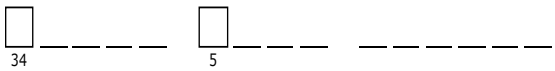
Asian folk metal



Jug band



Smooth jazz



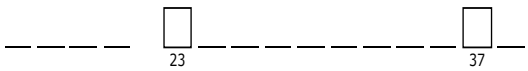
Ocarina



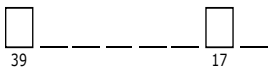
Handbell choir



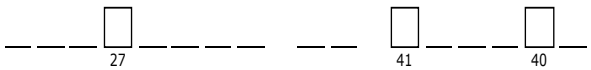
Piano

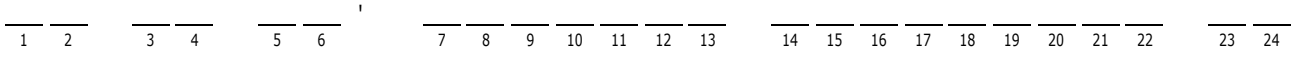


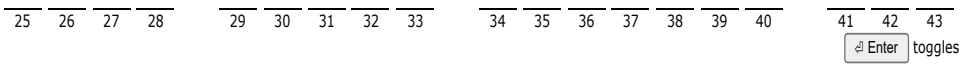
Harpsicord



Bluegrass







Enter toggles music, Refresh to start over

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Judging By Its Cover 2: Even Judgier

This is a music identification puzzle.

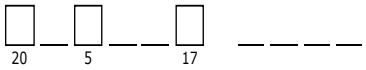
Type titles of these cover songs directly into the page. Press **Enter** to toggle music on the current line. **Refresh** to reload or start over.

While you may enjoy these songs, it may be bad idea to look for the originals - many are far too catchy.

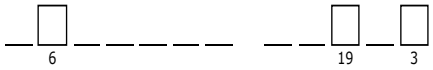
Piano/Viola



Bardcore



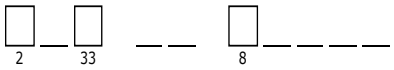
Orchestra



Accordion



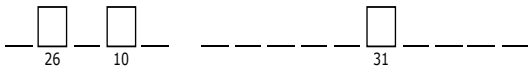
String quartet



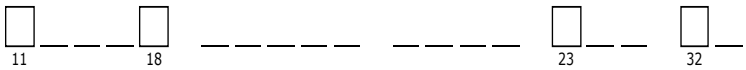
Bardcore



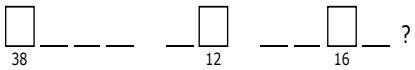
Guzheng



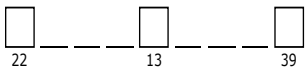
Elevator music



Strings



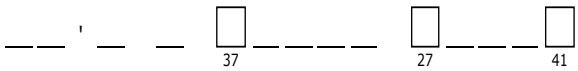
Metal guitar



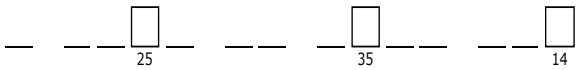
Bardcore

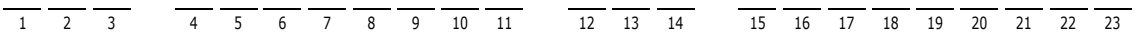


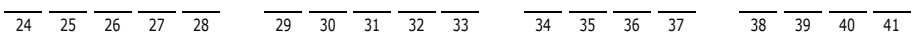
3 variations



Marching band







Enter toggles music, Refresh to start over

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Mad Scientist Store

If you're a mad scientist, you need a wide range of equipment. You need regular science tools like Pipettes and Syringes. But you also have unique needs, like Van De Graaf generators and brains in glass jars. At Mad Scientist Store, we have all your needs in one simple catalog. This month we have several secret specials, hidden in the grid below.

Letters slide into the grid horizontally or vertically without changing order within a group leaving one letter in each cell. Thick lines represent all the word breaks, but letters will slide past them as needed. Ignore the shaded boxes until you have inserted the letters. There will be 14 words/abbreviations total. There are no one-letter words.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	A I A W	R G E T	A L E Y	C D A R	I O N U	H M C O	M P O D	E P K L
C U B L								
H E L A								
A C O L								
C H I S								
N H I R								
S N P U								
M M E L								
S S T O								

After you have inserted all the letters, extract those that are shaded to form the final answer. Extract the word from the coloured squares using the column numbers shown under the answer blanks. When two letters of the same colour appear in a column, work in row order from ***bottom to top****.*

This will get a four word answer telling you a basic technique of Mad Science.

Final Answer: __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __

Column: 6 3 1 8 2 2 7 4 3 5 3 6 4 8 6 5

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Oops! All Baerries

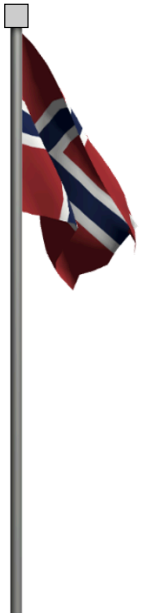
Can you find the 10 items berried in this puzzle? Hopefully it's not Barry hard. After you've found them all, you'll need to focus on what was left out.

	R	B	L	U	E		E	A	L
B		L	A	C	S	T	N	A	S
O	W	M	M	R		P	S	A	R
S	H	E	A	A	O	F	B	A	E
T	I	S	D	N	O	B		R	D
W	T	R	Y		I	B	L	O	N
I	E		K	C	A	L	B	C	A
C	K	F	R	O	M	B	O	A	S
K	R	R	Y	S	T	R	A	W	

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Red Flags

Wow, that's a lot of red flags! It seems like they're trying to tell me something, but what could it be?







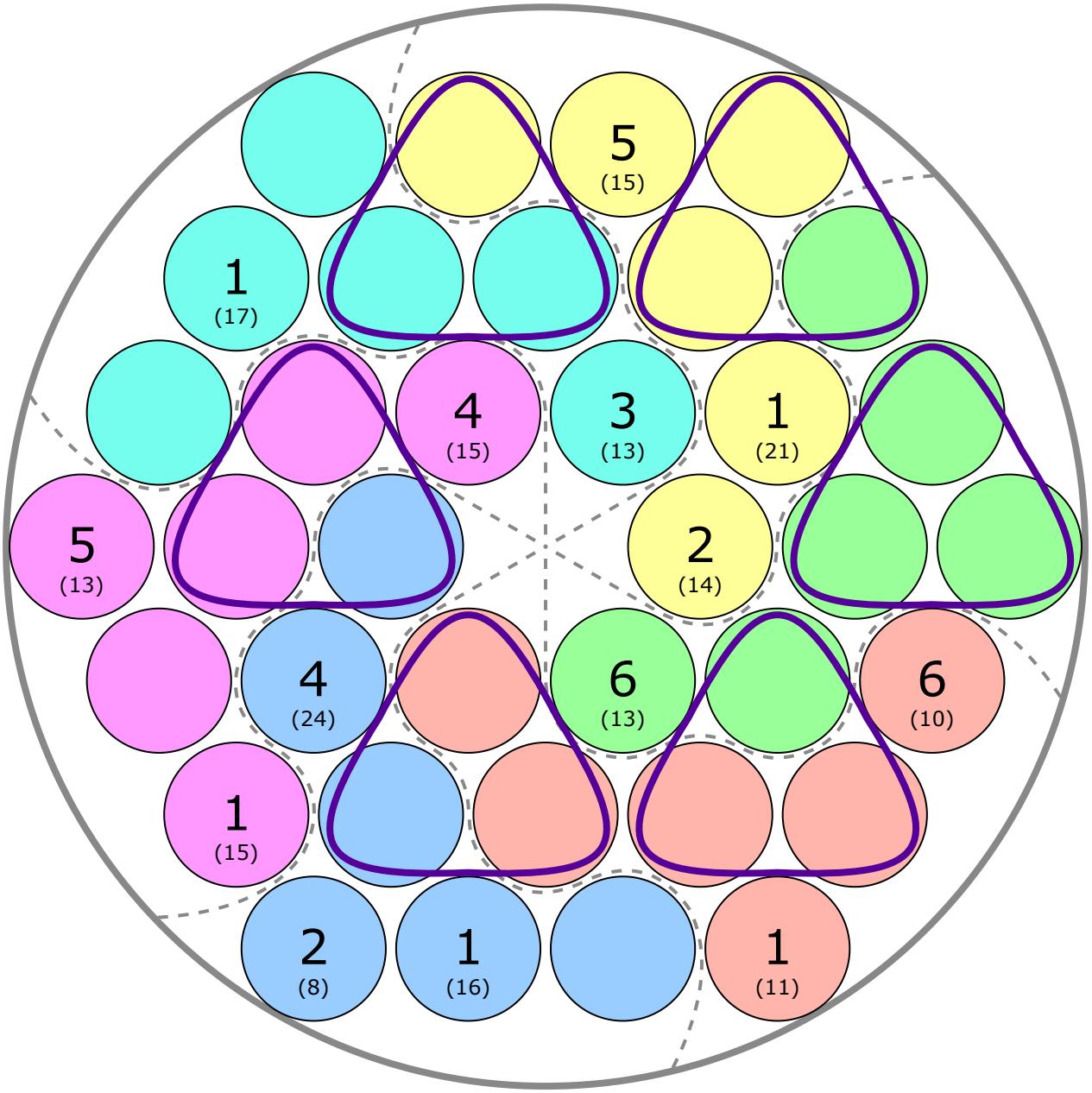

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Round Pegs, Triangle Holes

Below is a collection of 36 pegs, arranged into six regions spiraling out from the center.

These circles need to be filled with the digits 1-6, subject to a few rules:

- Each region is color coded, and also separated by dashed lines.
  Each region contains pegs for the digits 1-6, used exactly once each.
- Some digits are already given, shown in a larger font.
- No adjacent pegs contain the same digit.
- Numbers in parentheses (smaller font) are the sums of the digits from all adjacent pegs.



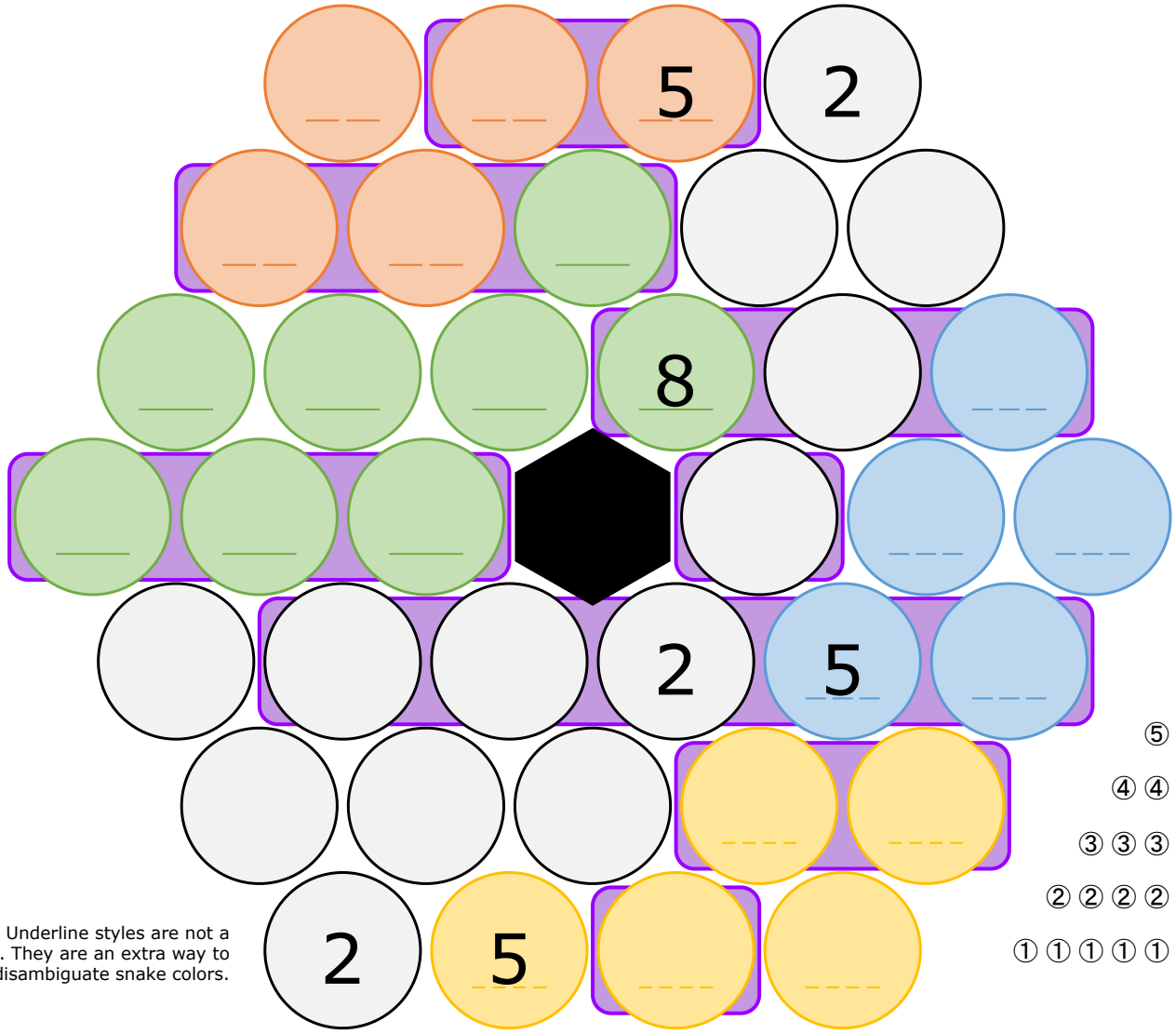
You need to squeeze clusters of three pegs into those six triangular holes.
They'd probably pack tighter if summed together.

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Snakes In A Sudoku

Below is a Sudoku-like grid. The rules are:

- The distribution of digits is pyramidal.
  There are eight 1s, seven 2s, six 3s, five 4s, four 5s, three 6s, two 7s, and a single 8.
- Each ⟷ row and hexagonal diagonal ↘↗ contains only unique digits – no duplicates.
  However, the middle black hexagon is a barrier. Duplicates can exist on either side of that barrier.
- A snake is any sequence of adjacent and consecutively numbered cells starting at 1. In this puzzle, an optimal snake grouping creates seven snakes: one of length 8, three of length 5, and three of length 2. The tail numbers of each of these snakes have been provided. For the four longest snakes, all member cells for a given snake share the same color and underline.



Note: Underline styles are not a code. They are an extra way to disambiguate snake colors.

- Finally, sum digits within each indicated region:

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The Hawaiian Express

Yes, I said water trains. Laugh if you must, detective, but this is a deadly serious business. It's been a bumpy road, but even a blind man can see that Preston Harcourt is a visionary genius. The first trans-Pacific railway will connect Seattle to Honolulu to Tokyo by this time next year and make investors filthy rich. But Mr. Harcourt has made many enemies along the way. Now he's disappeared somewhere in these sea sectors, and we fear a jealous rival has murdered him. We've launched a number of search buoys. Here's what we can tell you:

- Every cell must be either shaded or unshaded. A few known shaded cells have been filled in for you.
- Cells containing search buoys are never shaded.
- Each search buoy has reported back a positive integer which is the number of unshaded cells it can see in the four cardinal directions, including its own cell. Buoys can see beyond other buoys but not beyond shaded cells or the edges of the map.
- Communications are garbled from some buoys, represented by question marks. We know these cells are unshaded, but we can't tell how many unshaded cells these buoys can see.
- Buoys that are underlined have their views blocked in exactly 3 cardinal directions by shaded cells and/or map edges.
- Buoys that are not underlined do not have their views blocked in exactly 3 cardinal directions.

The board of directors and angel investors are quite nervous. Please find out what's happened to Mr. Harcourt!



	1		1		
		?			3
6					
			5		
	8				
3					3
				4	
3		■			2
8					
			3		
	3	?			■
	?			2	
			■		1
1		3		2	
					6
		4			
	5				
?			?	3	?

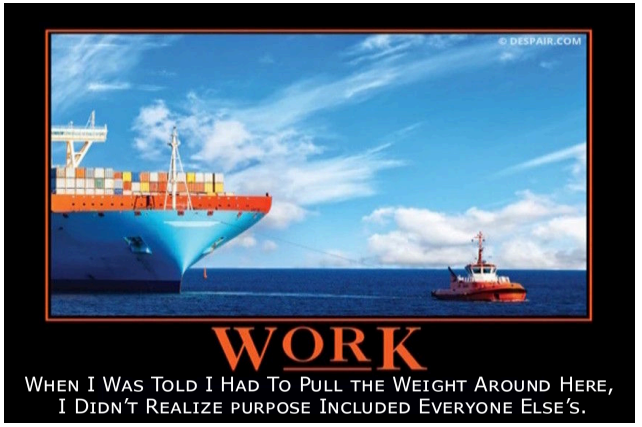
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Trite Optimism

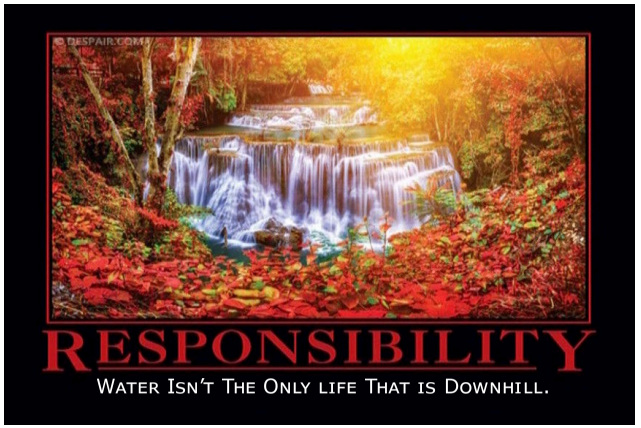
Our *initial* morale budget was reduced to just $18. But don't *despair*! I found a specialty online vendor that can help. What do you think of these posters?

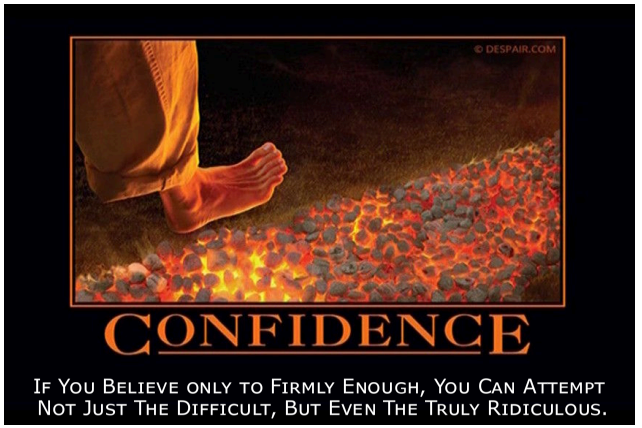


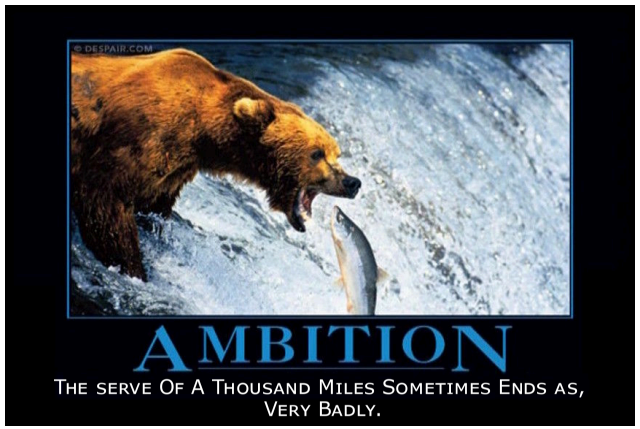


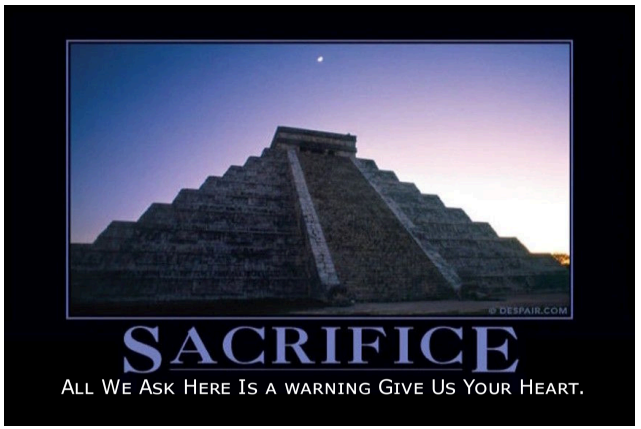


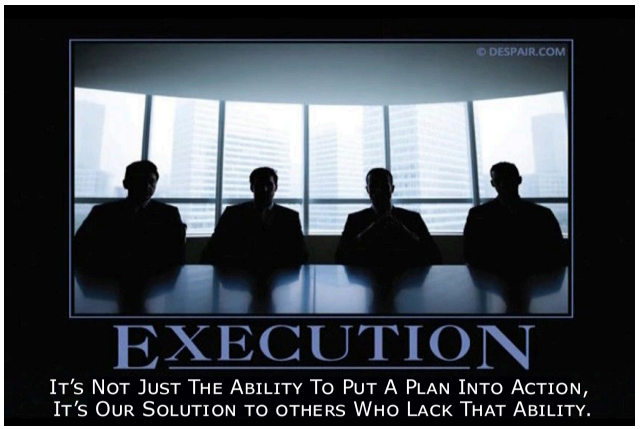










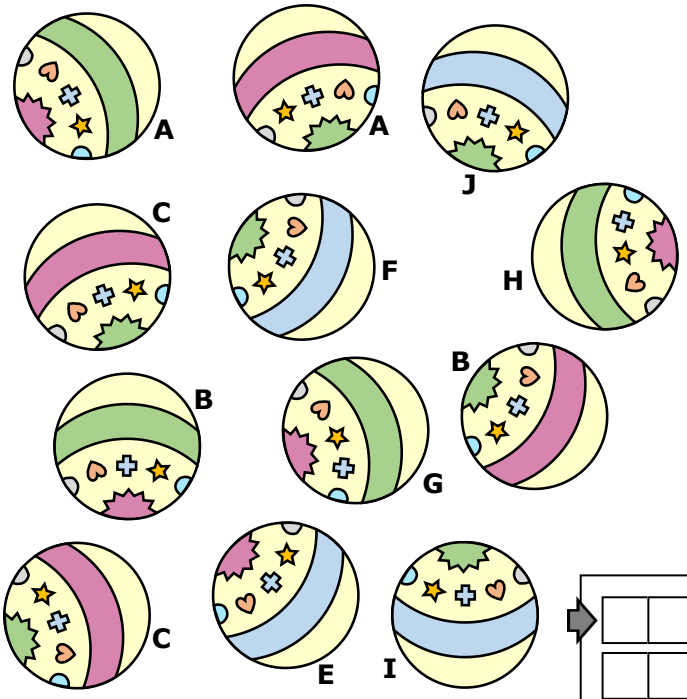


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Unfortunate Events Part I

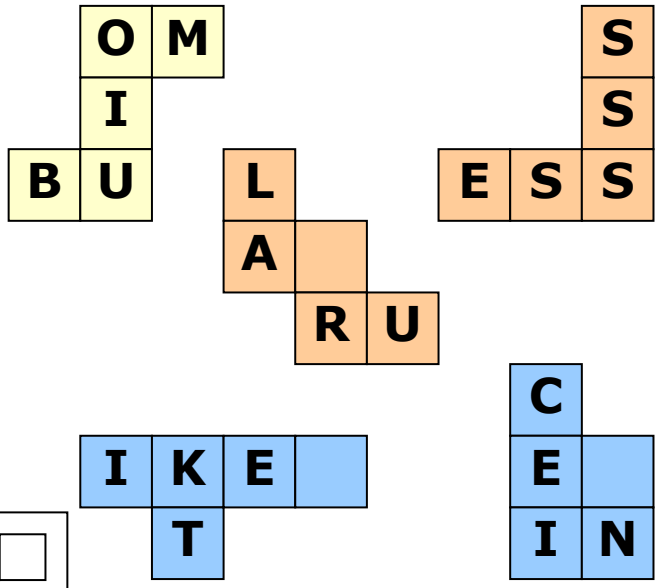
EVENT: DROPPING THE BALL

One ball you're juggling doesn't match any other. Throw it out. Add letters for identical balls (e.g. A+B=C) and resume juggling.



EVENT: PICKING UP THE PIECES

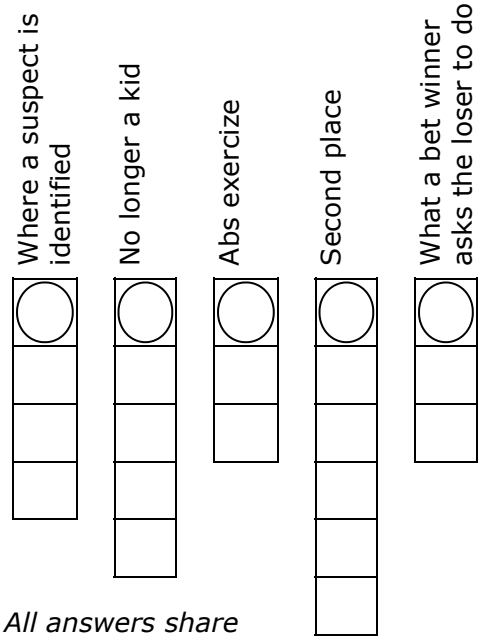
Oh no! You've broken a family heirloom and need to repair it. You remember it was square and pieces of the same color did not touch.



ANSWER WORDLE

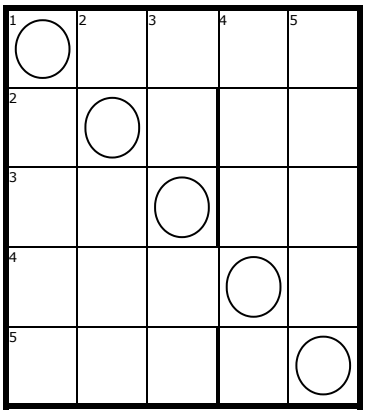
EVENT: BREAKING UP

They say that breaking up is hard to do… but if you tee up *the set* up, *you'll get a breakthrough.*



Hint: All answers share something in common, which may help you entertain them.

EVENT: GOING DOWNHILL FAST



Across

1. Simon Templar alter ego
2. Wiser companion
3. Chinese tech company
4. What one might say to two and zero? (2 wd)
5. Somebody who used to know

Down

1. A vague size description (2 wd)
2. San Antonio fort
3. American _____ (musical)
4. Donkey to a Brit
5. An alternate nickname of one called Gertie

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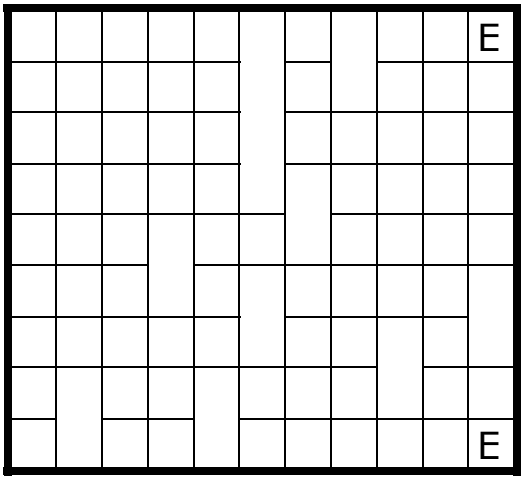
Unfortunate Events Part II

EVENT: LOSING THE MOVIE AUDIO



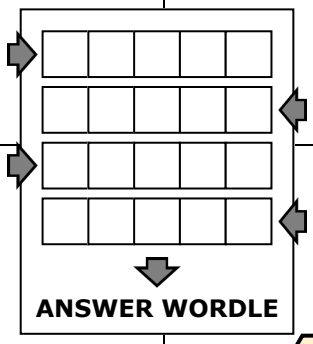
If the audio goes out in the movies, subtitles don't help if they are images! Find these adjacent two-word movies (always in correct order). The unused 2 images are a clue to the word you seek.

EVENT: GETTING LOST IN A CAVE



Fit the entries below into the "cave" grid above, one entry per row, starting in any column where the entry fits. Tall boxes indicate the only adjacent letters that match between rows. Read the gray boxes from the top down for the little-known way out. Two letters are given to get you started.

- BATGUANO
- CURTAIN
- DARKNESS
- PASSAGES
- SODASTRAW
- SPELUNKER
- STALACTITE
- STALAGMITE
- WATERDRIPS



EVENT: LOSING THE GAME

Sometimes it's just a little *bit too much* to deal with the *tumultuous* outcome of a *tabletop game*.

BLUE CRABS

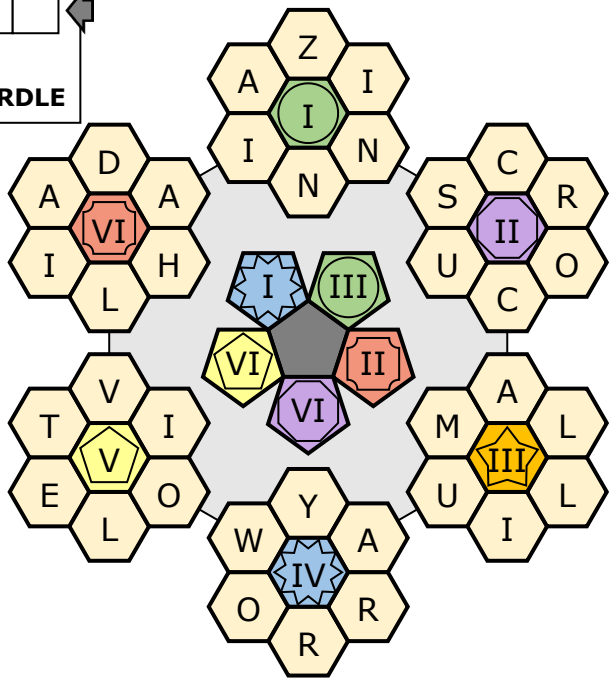
CATNAP

ONUS

SKIER

CHESTS

EVENT: ALLERGY SEASON



How can you describe the worst type of allergy effects? Decode my hybrid in the center (it's so easy: pick the outer ring's flower then pick its petal)!

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Unfortunate Events Part III

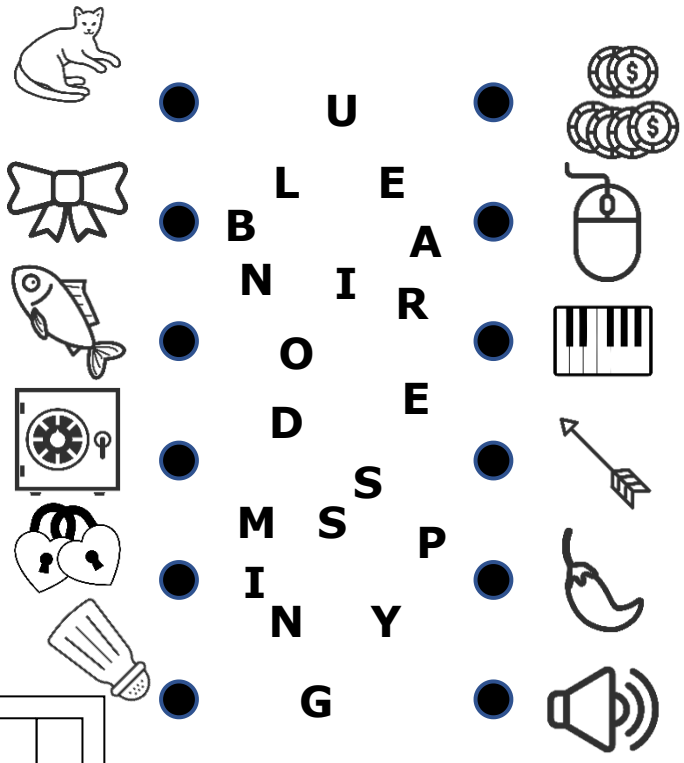
EVENT: FEELING UNDER THE WEATHER

	I	L	4	U	O		T	O	T	H
S	K	E	A		Y	K	C	O	R	E
A		T	N	A	D	E		E	2	C
3	O	D	O	R		E	T	N	H	I
D	N	1	M	A	T	R	T	N	E	E
L	O	C	Y	P	A	I	N	8	M	F

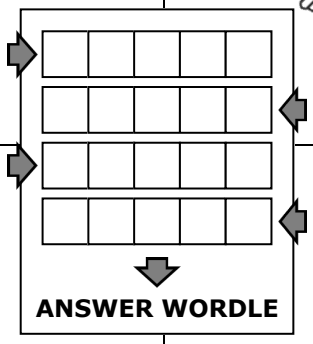
- Warcraft maker
- Barbra's Funny Girl track
- Presidential anthem
- Scorpions' signature song
- Foreigner's complaint about a girl

Hint: One symbol is not used, but the others are quite important. Use the extra data you find on your path on the weather for that path.

EVENT: FRIENDS CHANGE



ANSWER WORDLE



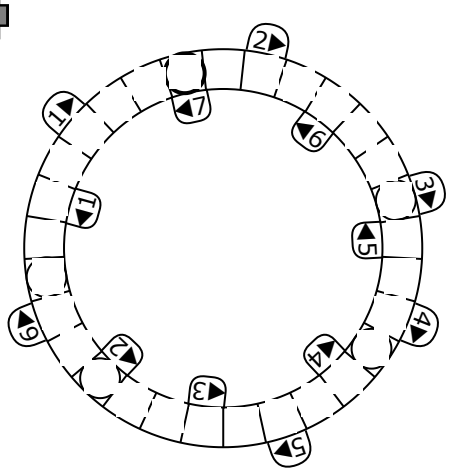
EVENT: ENDLESS WORK



Connect paths between matching numbers, *filling every cell* but without crossing thick borders.

When you're done, count the cells on each path (not including the endpoints).

EVENT: RUNNING IN CIRCLES



CLOCKWISE

1. A washing sponge (nonstandard spelling)
2. Slightly drunk
3. Put a question to
4. Egyptian river
5. Ecstatic joy
6. Parts of speech expressing action, existence, or occurrence

ANTI-CLOCKWISE

1. Latte made with half-and-half
2. Wheel-made groove
3. Peel fruit skin off with a specific knife
4. Chain element
5. Speaks
6. Pocket bread
7. April ___ Day

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Yolo

















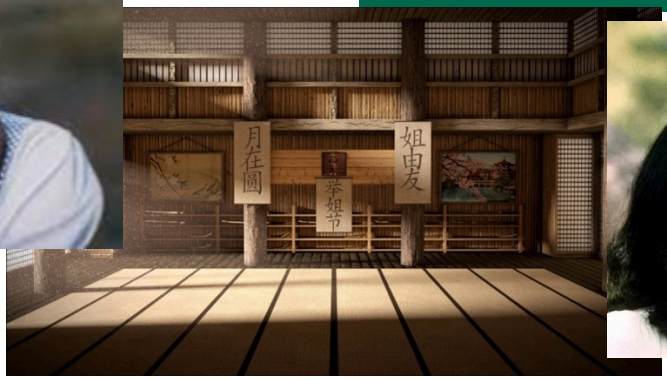
















B B B C D D D F G G G H H H H J K L L L M N P P R S T T T T Y Y Y Z

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Zero, One Two Many!

Zero, you put One Two many numbers in the grid! I noticed while reading it row by row, top to bottom. Now that's probably a bad idea… why will solvers want to solve it now? It's on the tip of my tongue…

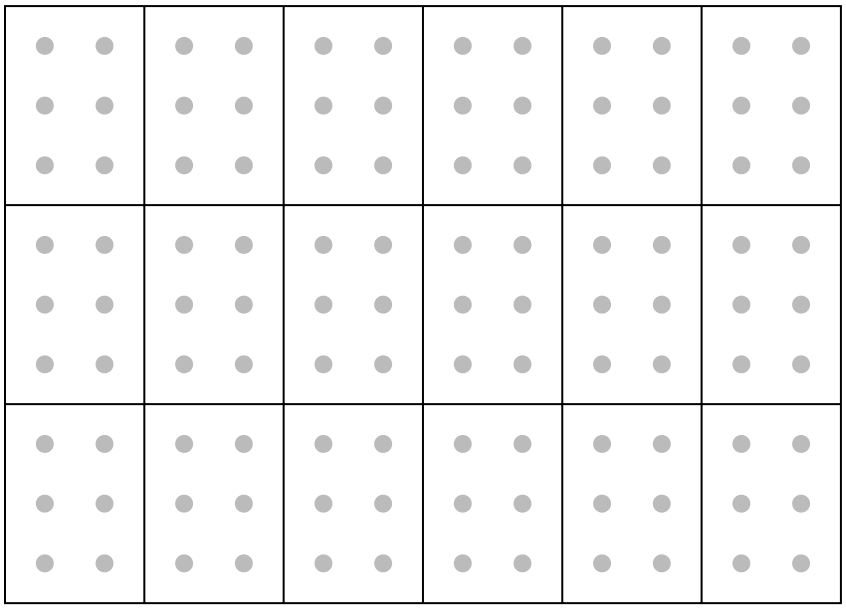
3	1	5	4			7		9
	9	2	7		8	0		6
		6	2	5	9	1	4	
8	6	3	0		1		7	
		9	6	3	7	4	1	
	7	0			2	6	5	3
0	4	1	5	2		8		
2			9		6	3	0	1
6		8		0	4	2		5

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Banned

This is a metapuzzle. Step 1: Solve the four related feeder puzzles (with the same "banned" icon in the upper right corner as this puzzle) to find clues and get started.

Step 2: Use the clues you've gathered and the grid below to find a secret message.



_ _

Step 3: Use the above secret message to find the final clue.
(You may submit any intermediate answer into the answer system to clarify the hint for the next step.)

_ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _

Step 4: Use the above final clue to answer the question, "**what was banned**"?
(You may submit any intermediate answer into the answer system to clarify the hint for the next step.)

_ _

This is the final answer.

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A Series Of Unfortunate Events

This is a meta puzzle. Use the final answers to collect one final Event. Then use the finale Event and the penultimate answers from the Unfortunate Events Parts I––III puzzles, and faster than you can say "*Lemony Snicket*" you'll start to see a pleasant ending for all thirteen unfortunate events.

FINALE EVENT:

- Unfortunate Events Part I: ☐☐☐☐☐
- Unfortunate Events Part II: ☐☐☐☐☐
- Unfortunate Events Part III: ☐☐☐☐☐

FINALE WORDLE

EVENTS:

- BAD 10 ◯☐☐☐☐
- ROOM 3 ◯☐☐☐☐
- WINDOW 13 ◯☐☐☐☐
- MILL 11 ◯☐☐☐☐
- ACADEMY 12 ◯☐☐☐☐
- ELEVATOR 5 ◯☐☐☐☐
- VILLAGE 7 ◯☐☐☐☐
- HOSPITAL 6 ◯☐☐☐☐
- CARNIVOROUS 8 ◯☐☐☐☐
- SLOPE 1 ◯☐☐☐☐
- GRIM 4 ◯☐☐☐☐
- PENULTIMATE 9 ◯☐☐☐☐
- ??? 2 ◯☐☐☐☐

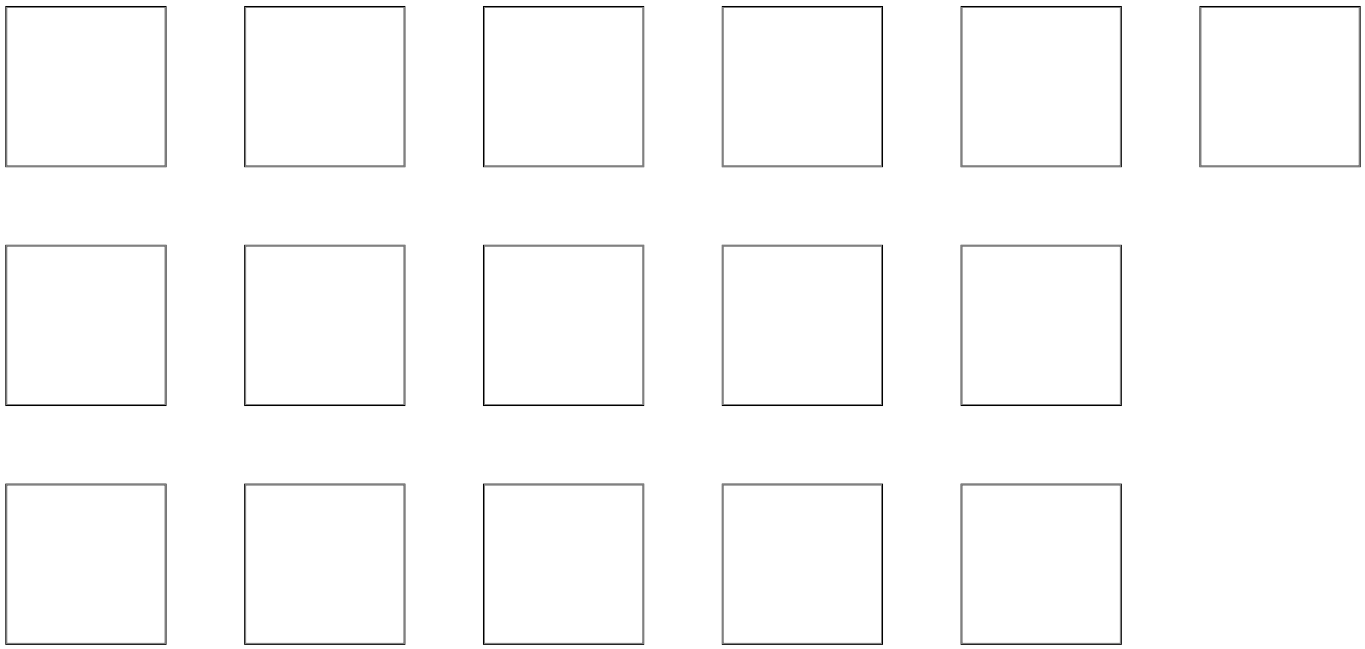
ANSWER: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13

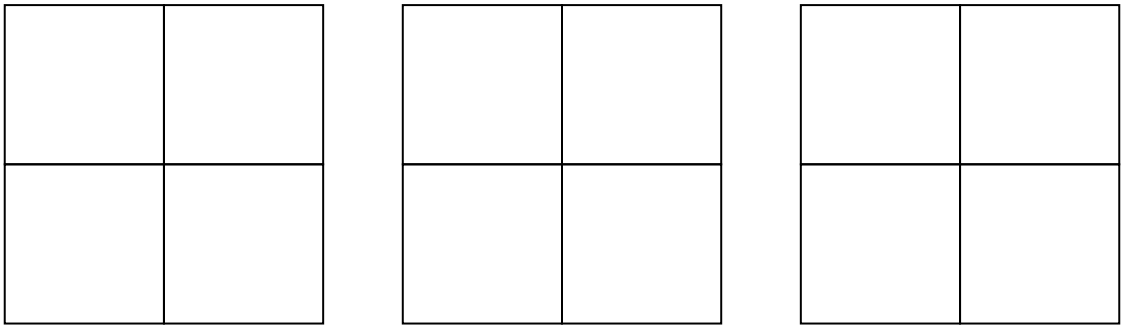
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Square Dance

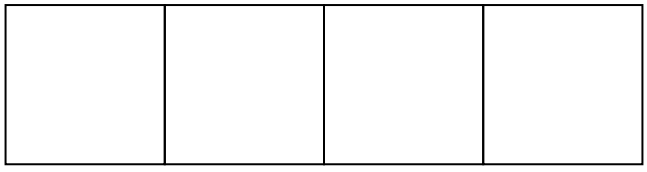
This is a metapuzzle. The input for this puzzle comes from four other puzzles: ***Argument Checker****,* ***Big Ideas****,* ***Four Crosses*** *and* ***Mad Scientist Store****. When you enter a correct solution to each of those puzzles, you will be given a set of four fragments each with four letters. When you've solved all four puzzles, you'll have a total of 16 fragments. Reformat each fragment by adding a line break between the 2nd and 3rd letter to make these 16 2x2 tiles:*



Now rearrange twelve of the tiles to make three word squares, where all four rows in each square are words and all four columns (read top to bottom) are also 4-letter words. Cutting them out might help but probably isn't necessary or desirable.



Take the four ***remaining*** *tiles and arrange them left to right as two eight letter rows.*



Read the three-word phrase which is the clue for the three-word bad idea final answer, the second word of which is 'and'.

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